only ones who would be released. Kundan Lal and Prem Dutt were handed down terms of imprisonment of seven years and five years respectively. Mahavir, Shiv Verma, Jaidev Kapoor and Vijay Kumar Sinha were sentenced to transportation for life. That left Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru. They were to be hanged by the neck until dead. On 23 March 1931, they were sent to the gallows, which they faced with unmatched valour and chutzpah. Be that as it may, Professor Chaman Lal's memorable lament, 'Rajguru, Sukhdev and Bhagat Singh's hanging was nothing but judicial murder—and that too performed in a hurry, with the colonial state clearly in a state of panic,'[11] reminds us of Mirza Ghalib's immortal incantation: '*Hui muddat ke Ghalib mar gaya par yaad aata hai / Vo har ek baar par kehna ki yoon hota tou kya hota*' ('Long years have passed since Ghalib died, but still his memory torments / Because it was he who always asked: "If it had been different, how different would it have been?"'). If Bhagat Singh had lived, what difference would his life have made? We will never know.